Lukas Hetzer | M.Sc.

Hertie School – Jacques Delors Centre – Alexanderstraße 3, 10178 Berlin, DE

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Research & teaching interests

Topics: European integration, crisis politics, public opinion, political communication, digital policy
Methods: Quantitative research, large-scale data infrastructure, natural language processing, causal inference

Academic positions & experience

Current

Hertie School of Governance, Jacques Delors Centre — Berlin (DE)
Research Associate — *10/2026–present*
Member of the DFG- & SNF-funded Research Unit "Reconfiguring Europe: Between Competence and control" (Reconf.EU, Coordination Project)

Previous

University of Cologne, Department of Political Science — Cologne (DE)
Doctoral Researcher — *10/2022–09/2026*
Member of the Chair of European and Multilevel Politics (Prof. Dr. Sven-Oliver Proksch), involved in:

- Horizon 2020 project *Observatory for Political Texts in European Democracies; Work Package 5 - Parliamentary, government and legal texts* (OPTED, WP5)
- ERC project *Democracy without Majorities: Political Representation under Minority Rule* (MINORITYRULE)
- Teaching (B.Sc. & M.Sc. level), thesis supervision (B.Sc. & M.Sc. level), and academic self-administration

Ludwig-Maximilians-University Munich, Geschwister-Scholl-Institute — Munich (DE)
Visiting Scholar — *10/2024–11/2024*
Hosted by the Chair of Political Systems and European Integration (Prof. Dr. Klaus Goetz).

GESIS – Leibniz Institute for the Social Sciences — Mannheim (DE)
Specialist for Data Management and Analysis — *10/2021–09/2022*
Member of the German Longitudinal Election Team, involved in:

- VW Foundation project *Threat to Democracy? Conspiracy Theories and their Impact on Voting Behavior* (DemThreat)
- Outreach & Knowledge Transfer for the German Longitudinal Election Study (GLES)

Ghent University, Department of Public Governance and Management — Ghent (BE) / remote
Research Intern — *11/2020–05/2021*
INAPP (Italy) project *Policy Interventions under Globalization and Technological Change*

University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam Institute for Social Science Research — Amsterdam (NL)
Research Assistant — *10/2019–04/2021*
Assistant to Prof. Dr. Theresa Kuhn, Challenges to Democratic Representation Research Group

Humboldt University Berlin, Department of Social Sciences — Berlin (DE)
Research Assistant — *11/2017–08/2019*
Assistant to Prof. Dr. Heike Klüver, Chair of Comparative Political Behavior

Education

University of Cologne, Cologne Graduate School — Cologne (DE)
PhD Political Science — *10/2022–present*
Thesis title: *Politics under Pressure: Crisis Governance, Decision-Making, and Public Responses*
Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Sven-Oliver Proksch & Prof. Dr. Alexia Katsanidou

University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam Institute for Social Science Research — Amsterdam (NL)
M.Sc. Social Sciences Research — *09/2019–08/2021*

GPA: 8.61 (excellent, highest distinction)
Thesis: *Regional Inequality and European Fiscal Solidarity in Times of Crisis: How Regional Wealth and Covid-19 Impact Shape Public Support for EU Risk Sharing*

Humboldt University Berlin, Department of Social Sciences — Berlin (DE)
B.Sc. Social Sciences — *10/2016–07/2019*
GPA: 1.4 (excellent)
Thesis: *Position Taking in EU Parliament Speeches after the 2004 Enlargement: Adaptive Behavior of Newcomers measured through Legislative Speech*

Maastricht University, Faculty of Psychology and Neuroscience — Maastricht (NL)
B.Sc. Psychology (not completed) — *09/2015–08/2016*

Awards & grants

Faculty of Management, Economics, and Social Sciences, University of Cologne
Junior Teaching Award (2,000€) — *01/2026*
Awarded by the Faculty Board based on outstanding student evaluations for the course *European Politics in Times of Crisis*

Reinhard Selten Institute (ECONTribute Cluster of Excellence)
Selten Grant (2,000€) — *10/2024*
Project: *Emergency Politics in the European Union*

Teaching

University of Cologne
Advanced Survey Methods and Challenges to Democracy (B.Sc./M.Sc.) — *Summer 2025 – Winter 2026/2027*
Survey methods (sampling, measurement, vignette & conjoint experiments, AI conversational interviewing, preregistration, ethics, analysis) and implementation in Qualtrics

University of Cologne
Tutorial Coordination: Foundations of European Politics (B.Sc.) — *Summer 2025 & 2026*
Recruiting, supervising and instructing a team of tutors; Organizing the content and structure of the tutorials (14 Groups) as part of the lecture "Foundations of European Politics"
(Prof. Dr. Sven-Oliver Proksch)

University of Cologne
Digitalization & AI – Shaping the Future of European Politics and the Way We Study It (B.Sc.) — *Winter 2025/26*
Course on EU digital governance and regulation (AI Act, DSA), AI-assisted quantitative & qualitative research methods, and foresight methods

University of Cologne
European Politics in Times of Crisis (B.Sc.) — *Summer & Winter 2024/25*
Courses on crisis governance and rhetoric in the EU; include applied introductions to R

Thesis supervision & mentorship

University of Cologne
Supervision of B.Sc. theses (8 theses)
Supervision of M.Sc. theses (1 thesis)
Mentor & reference for BA students (3 students) — *2024–2026*

Publications

Journal articles (peer reviewed)

[1] Rath, Jasmin; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Berz, Jan; Wurthmann, Constantin; Wagner, Sarah (2026). Caught in the Crossfire. Electoral Spillover Effects of Accommodating the Radical Right. ***Party Politics***
.

[2] Schwalbach, Jan; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Proksch, Sven-Oliver; Rauh, Christian; Sebők, Miklós (2026). The ParlLawSpeech Parliamentary Text Data Collection >3 Million Parliamentary Bills, Laws, and Speeches from 8 Legislatures. ***Nature Scientific Data***, *13*, 1327.

[3] Riebe, Frauke; Wurthmann, Constantin; **Hetzer, Lukas** (2026). Beyond Proximity: Representational Isolation and Emotional Response in Climate Politics. ***Representation***, 1–20.

[4] **Hetzer, Lukas**; Burgoon, Brian (2024). Regional crises and European fiscal preferences: how regional Covid-19, economic downturn, and migration shape support for EU risk sharing. ***Journal of European Public Policy***, *31*(10), 3093–3127.

Working papers

[1] Anonymized for peer review
Journal of European Public Policy | Under Review

[2] **Hetzer, Lukas**; Lenz, Alexa. The Efficiency-Deliberation Trade-Off of Crisis Politics: Evidence from Parliamentary Legislative Activity in Germany.

[3] Anonymized for peer review
European Journal of Political Research | Revise and resubmit

[4] Proksch, Sven-Oliver; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Wäckerle, Jens; Rath, Jasmin; Hoffmeyer-Zlotnik, Paula. Framing Minority Governments: How Strategic Narratives Shape Voter Evaluations.

[5] Anonymized for peer review
British Journal of Political Science | Revise and resubmit

[6] Anonymized for peer review
Journal of European Public Policy | Revise and resubmit

[7] Anonymized for peer review
World Politics | Under Review

Edited volumes

[1] Riebe, Frauke; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Wurthmann, Constantin (2022). Die Bundestagswahl 2021: Perspektiven und Daten aus der deutschen Wahlstudie. *easy_social_sciences* 67.

Contributions in edited volumes

[1] Blumenberg, Manuela; Bieber, Ina; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Pollak, Reinhard; Stroppe, Anne-Kathrin (2024). Pandemie und Wahlverhalten . In: *Wahlen und Wähler: Analysen zur Bundestagswahl 2021*. Springer VS, 179–204.

[2] Rossmann, Joss; Wurthmann, Constantin; Riebe, Frauke; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Blumenberg, Manuela (2022). Einführung: Die Bundestagswahl 2021: Eine außergewöhnliche Wahl in ungewöhnlichen Zeiten. In: *easy_social_sciences* 67, pp. 4–8.

[3] Dippel, Alina S.; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Burger, Axel (2022). Links oder rechts? Die ideologische Selbstverortung von Wähler:innen und ihre Wahrnehmung von Parteien in Deutschland. In: *easy_social_sciences* 67, pp. 19–29.

Policy reports

[1] Balduini, Sveva; Burgoon, Brian; Busemeyer, Marius; Gualtieri, Valentina; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Luppi, Matteo; Nicoli, Francesco; Sacchi, Stefano (2022). Secular Economic Challenges and Public Support for Policy Interventions: Technological change and globalization in a randomized survey experiment in eight countries. INAPP.

Datasets

[1] Schwalbach, Jan; **Hetzer, Lukas**; Proksch, Sven-Oliver; Rauh, Christian; Sebők, Miklós (2025). ParlLawSpeech.

Reviewer

(Web of Science) *Reviewer for Journal of European Public Policy (2x), European Journal of Political Research (1x), European Union Politics (2x), Young Journal of European Affairs (2x)*

Conference participations & presentations

Invited talks

* *upcoming*

EU Governance Colloquium, Jacques Delors Centre, Hertie School Berlin	2026*
Computational Exchange Speaker Series (Prof. Haim), LMU Munich	2026
Amsterdam Center for European Studies (Prof. Kuhn), University of Amsterdam	2025

Chair of Empirical Theories of Politics (Prof. Knill), LMU Munich 2025
Text-as-Data Reading Group (TaDa) Speaker Series, online 2025
Computational Social Science Doctoral Workshop, Sciences Po Paris 2024
Chair of Political Systems and European Integration (Prof. Goetz), LMU Munich 2024

Conferences

ECPR Standing Group on Parliaments (SGoP) 2025
EPSA European Political Science Association Conference 2025, 2024, 2023
CompText Interdisciplinary Conference on Computational Text Analysis 2025, 2024, 2023
DVPW German Political Science Association Congress 2024
ECPR Standing Group on the European Union (SGEU) 2024
ECPR General Conference 2022

Workshops & colloquia

Capacity-building in the European Union, University of Bremen 2026
Navigating time pressure in the European Union, LMU Munich 2026
Cologne–Zurich–Innsbruck Political Science Workshop, Tratzberg 2026
A multi-level analysis of the EU's social turn, University of Konstanz 2026
Political Science Speaker Series, University of Cologne 2025
Gesis Workshop on validation of Large Datasets, online 2025
Cologne–Zurich European Politics Workshop, Filzbach 2024
Cologne Center for Comparative Politics Colloquium, University of Cologne 2023
OPTED Workshop 2022, 2023
Escaping the Politics Trap? EU Integration Pathways Beyond the Polycrisis, University of Amsterdam 2023
Political Representation and Behavior Workshop, University of Cologne 2023
EUI–YouGov "Solidarity in Europe" Survey Data Dissemination Workshop, EUI Florence 2023

Additional skills

Languages: English (native) · German (native) · Dutch (intermediate) · Italian (beginner)
Data analysis: R (expert) · Python (advanced) · Stata (advanced) · SPSS (basic)
Tools: GitHub · LaTeX / Overleaf · Qualtrics (advanced logic; JavaScript/HTML) · Microsoft Office